

Day 8 — Project Session 1: Research and Outline

Module: What is IKS? (Middle) · **Time:** 45 min

Learning objective

Each student commits to a specific topic, drafts a thesis sentence, and outlines a 5-minute presentation.

Materials

- Library books / curated reading list
- Project brief + rubric

Flow

Warm-up (5 min)

Brief: today's project work. Show the rubric on the wall. Cover the key criteria.

Core sprints (35 min)

Sprint 1 (10 min) — Thesis. Each student writes: - Working title - One-sentence thesis (specific claim about their topic) - 2 sources

Teacher rotates: 60 sec per student, asking “*What’s the specific claim? Not ‘X is interesting’ — what specifically are you arguing?*”

Sprint 2 (10 min) — Outline. 5-slide / 5-section outline: 1. The topic + named practitioner 2. What it claimed / did 3. One specific source (primary verse, theorem, or text) 4. Modern view / parallel 5. Honest limitation (what the tradition didn’t do)

Sprint 3 (15 min) — Begin slides / notes. Each student starts drafting their actual presentation content.

Wrap-up (5 min)

- Plan submitted at door.
- Preview Day 9: “*Tomorrow — rehearse and refine.*”

Homework

- Continue drafting at home. Tomorrow is for *refining*, not starting.

Differentiation

- **Tier up:** Add a counter-argument: “Some scholars dispute X” with citation.
- **Tier down:** Use the 5-section outline as your full structure.

Teacher notes

- The “specific claim” filter is the most useful intervention. Many students start with “Indian math is interesting” — push to “Mādhava’s series converges to π but converges slowly; here’s why that mattered.”